Food handler hygiene in Malaysia: Food Hygiene Regulations 2009 (one-page summary)

Plain-English summary of Part IV (Food handler) and related duties in the Food Hygiene Regulations 2009, P.U.(A) 95/2009, made under the Food Act 1983 [Act 281]. Prepared for the BiliMind "Boba Shop: Day One" demo.

This summary does not replace MOH food-handler training. Every food handler must still attend a food handler training course recognised by the Ministry of Health Malaysia and get the certificate. This page is not legal advice; the regulations may have been amended since 2009, so check the current text with the Food Safety and Quality Division, Ministry of Health Malaysia.

Who is a food handler (reg. 2)

- Anyone who is directly involved in preparing food, comes into contact with food or food-contact surfaces, or handles packaged or unpackaged food or appliances in food premises.
- Bubble-tea crew who scoop pearls, pour milk, seal cups or wash shakers are food handlers.

Before you start work (regs. 30, 31(1), 11)

- **Training:** attend food handler training and get a Certificate of Food Handlers Training from an institution specified by the Director (MOH-recognised).
- **Medical check and vaccination** by a registered medical practitioner (in practice, the anti-typhoid injection).
- The owner must not let you work without training, medical examination and vaccination, and must keep these records for inspection.

If you are ill (reg. 31(2))

- If you have, carry, or may have a food-borne disease: do not enter the food premises or handle food.
- Report your health condition to the management immediately.
- Stay off work until a registered medical practitioner certifies you cured and fit to work.

Clothing (reg. 32)

- Clean, suitable clothing that cannot contaminate food.
- A clean, light-coloured overall or apron, a head cover and footwear.
- Wear them only in the food premises; keep them in a cupboard or locker when not in use.

Personal hygiene (reg. 33)

- Keep yourself clean; fingernails short and clean.
- Remove your overall, apron or head cover before going to the toilet.
- Wash hands before starting work, immediately after the toilet, and after handling raw food or contaminated material.
- No behaviour that could contaminate food; nothing in pockets that could contaminate food.
- No jewellery, watches, pins or other accessories.

Clean premises and equipment (regs. 34, 35)

- Keep the premises free of rubbish, pests, dirt and cobwebs at all times.
- Use different cutting boards for raw and cooked food; sanitise raw-food equipment before using it for cooked food.
- Rinse cleaning chemicals off food-contact surfaces. Ice must be made from potable water and protected.
- No sweeping, wall cleaning or dusting while food is being handled. Throw out chipped, cracked or rusty appliances.
- Do not refreeze retail frozen food after thawing.

Preparing and serving (reg. 36)

- Do not handle unwrapped food with bare hands, and stop customers doing so.
- Never use your breath to open a bag or wrapper. Wipe hands with a clean towel.
- Keep hot food served hot above 60 °C; do not interrupt the cold chain.
- Food of swine origin: separate preparation and separate appliances from non-swine food.

Display and storage (regs. 37, 38)

- Protect ready-to-eat food on display (cabinet, cover, container).
- Store raw food apart from processed food, and never with cleaning agents or disinfectants.
- Keep food 15 cm from the wall and 20 cm above the floor; rotate stock first in, first out.
- Retail chilled food between -1 °C and 10 °C; frozen food at -18 °C. Do not overload chillers and freezers.

Penalties: most food-handler offences (regs. 30, 31, 33-38) carry a fine of up to RM 10,000 or imprisonment of up to 2 years; the clothing offence (reg. 32) carries a fine of up to RM 1,000. **Source:** Food Hygiene Regulations 2009, P.U.(A) 95/2009 (28 February 2009), text read from the FAOLEX database copy, https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/mal91581.pdf (accessed 10 October 2026). Summary written in our own words; the shop SOP in this folder is a fictional example.